

€122.5k signs 100 maintenance hires by 31 Dec, if the client can assess 55 a week

€122.5k

budget: €102.3k plan
+ €20.2k reserve,
released only on
results

€1,023

media cost per hire
(€1,225 if the reserve
is spent)

98%

of 314 assessment
slots used: capacity,
not money, is the limit

Plan

- €750 test in each pay-per-click channel in weeks 1-2, then buy hires cheapest first.
- Three new sources bring ~42 hires: past applicants + referrals, construction electricians, Polish border towns.
- Pace ≤55 assessments a week; applications until Tue 24 Nov, signatures by Fri 18 Dec.

How sure: 100 if funnel rates hold, with no slack (98% of slots used); pass rate 10% worse → ~92; 30% less budget → ~87.

Role	Hires	Spend	€ / hire
Electricians	30	€39.1k	€1,304
Mechatronics	45	€30.1k	€670
Automation	15	€17.4k	€1,162
Supervisors	10	€15.5k	€1,555
Total	100	€102.3k	€1,023



Top 3 risks → what I'll do

Assessment capacity: pace ≤55 a week, pre-screened sources first, ask for +9 slots. If assessments can't start 22 Oct: ~92 hires (100 then needs 60 a week).

Electrician supply: construction-electrician route needs your OK by 23 Oct; without it €130k.

Christmas: offers within 3 days, e-signature, stop spend Tue 24 Nov. At German process pace (8 + 12 days): ~92 hires; +9 slots a week restores 100.



What I need from you

- 55 assessments a week from Thu 22 Oct (+9 if possible)
- Day-1 export of past applicants (GDPR-checked)
- €1,000 referral bonus + one staff message
- Construction-electrician decision + bridge-course trainer by 23 Oct
- Approve €122.5k

Working back from 100 hires: ~308 qualified applicants for 314 assessment slots

Role	Hires	App → qualified	Qualified → passed	Passed → offer	Offer → signed	Qualified needed	Applications needed
Electricians	30	25%	50%	90%	70%	95	381
Mechatronics	45	25%	55%	90%	75%	121	485
Automation	15	25%	45%	90%	70%	53	212
Supervisors	10	23%	40%	85%	70%	42	183
Total	100					311	1,260

Where the rates come from: IAB (about 1 in 4 applications is suitable), Gem (interview pass rates), German offer-acceptance surveys. Each one is labelled on the Assumptions tab.

Latest useful application: work back from the last signature, Fri 18 Dec: offer → signed 7 days, interview → offer 3, assessment → interview 8, application → assessment 6. So applications must arrive by Tue 24 Nov (supervisors Tue 17 Nov).

Capacity check

98%

308 qualified applicants in the plan (from 1,495 applications) against 314 slots: 55 a week × 40 assessment days ÷ 7.

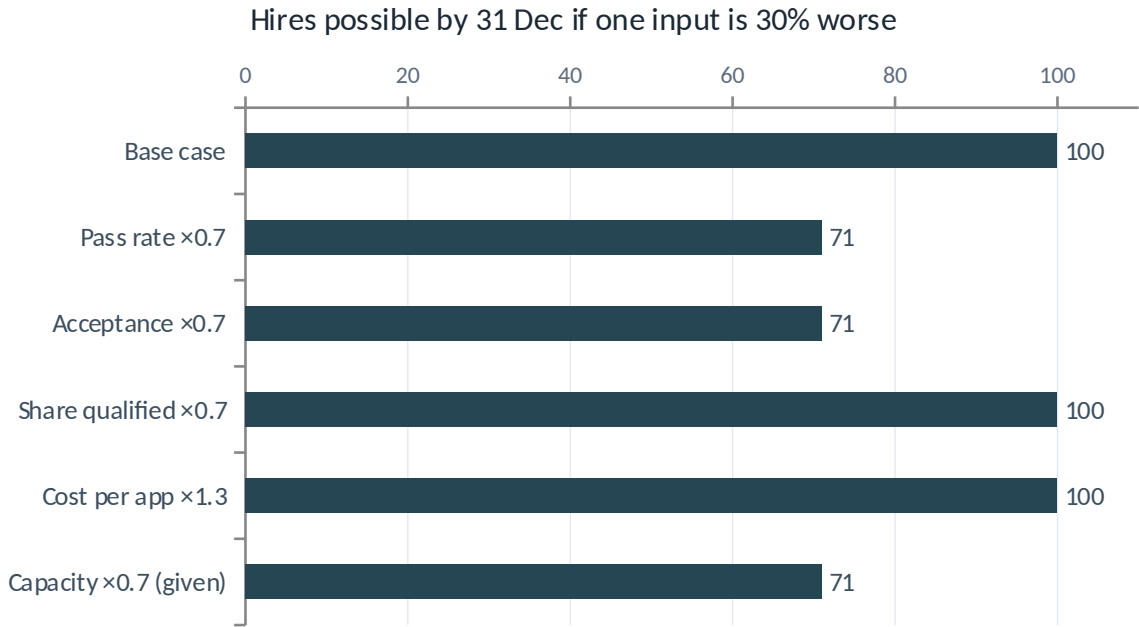
The plan fits, but with almost no headroom. Every week is paced to stay within 55 (Weekly tab).

Why 308, not 311: referrals and past applicants convert better than the table's standard rates, so the plan needs slightly fewer. Applications: 1,495, not 1,260, because the plan's channels average 21% qualified (social ads lower), below the ~25% baseline.

Electricians are hardest; a 30% worse pass rate costs ~29 hires that money can't buy back

Why electricians are hardest

- Scarcest trade in Brandenburg: 85.7% of vacancies have no suitable unemployed candidate, against 41.4% across all jobs (KOFA 2026).
- Dearest last hire: €2,272, the highest of the four roles (Funnel column H).
- No back door: no Polish route, and foreign-trained electricians need 2–4 months of recognition.
- Automation has a tighter pool and less channel headroom (22% of reachable people vs 12%), but needs only 15 and costs less per hire, so it is watched weekly.



Most sensitive: the pass rate. 30% worse means 440 qualified applicants for 314 slots, so only ~71 can be hired; spending more doesn't help. Acceptance ties, but fast offers protect it; the pass rate depends on the plant's own test and is only known after interviews (week-2 check). A weaker share qualified or dearer clicks only cost money, not hires: a 30% lower share qualified needs a €185k budget on a full re-run (cheap channels hit their caps); dearer clicks +30% media.

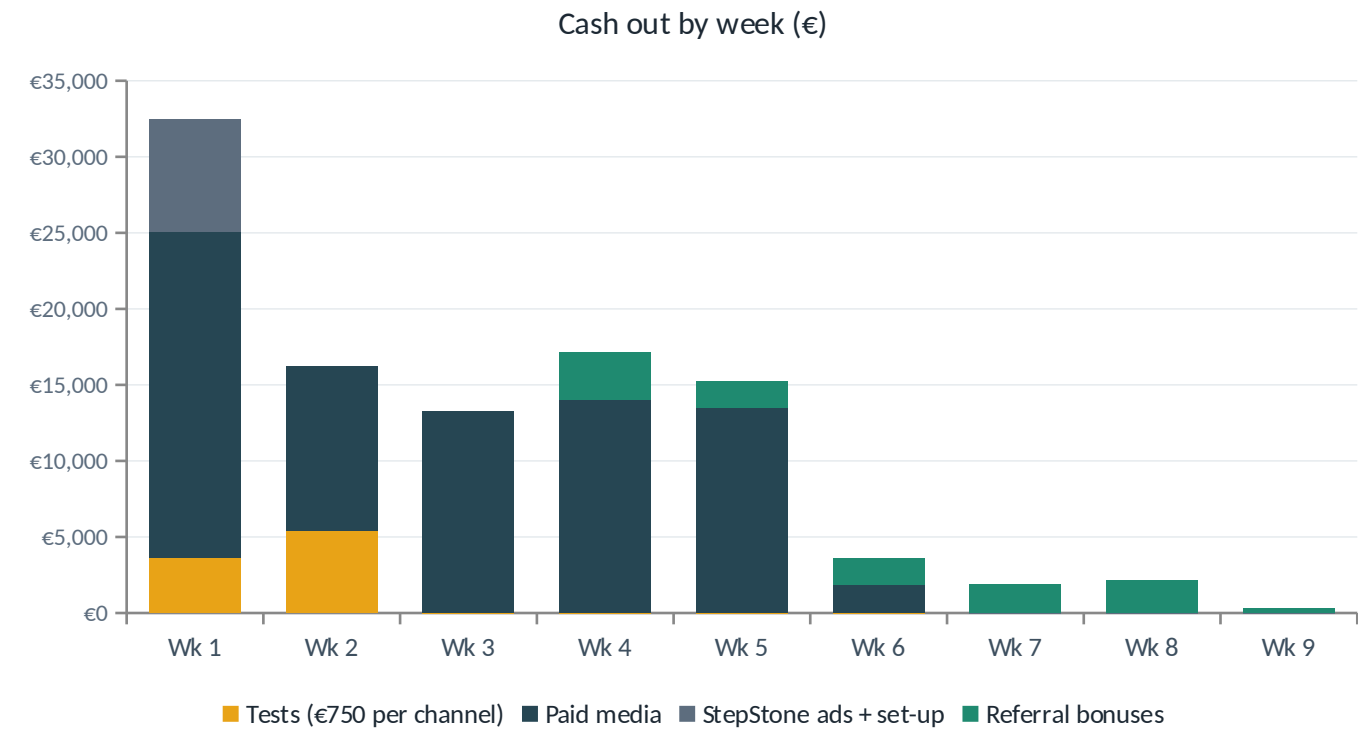
Every role buys its hires cheapest cost-per-hire first

Channel	Roles	Why	Spend	€ / qualified	€ / hire	Hires
Organic	E M A S	Free: careers site, BA Jobbörse, Google for Jobs	€0	€0	€0	20.0
Rediscovery	E M A S	Past applicants, already screened	€63	€5	€14	4.6
Polish corridor	M	Large pool across the border (≤40% of mechatronics)	€6.9k	€142	€383	18.0
Referrals	E M A S	Staff know the job; €1,000 bonus on signing	€11k	€370	€1,000	11.0
Handwerk→Industrie	E	Construction electricians: a new pool for the hardest role	€11.1k	€377	€1,329	8.4
StepStone	E M	Germany's main CV job board	€5.8k	€537	€1,564	3.7
LinkedIn	A S	PLC and Meister profiles (automation, supervisors)	€27.2k	€444	€1,687	16.1
Programmatic	E M A S	Indeed and other boards, paid per application	€35.7k	€717	€2,142	16.7
Meta	E M	Reaches people who aren't job-hunting	€1.5k	€820	€2,388	0.6
Google Search	E M A S	High intent, but the dearest	€3k	€1,044	€3,442	0.9
Total			€102.3k		€1,023	100

How it works

- Cost per hire = cost per application ÷ share qualified ÷ qualified → signed.
- Each channel is capped by how many people in the local talent pool it can reach.
- Each pay-per-click channel gets a €750 test per role first; Search and Meta stay at test level, and so does programmatic for automation and supervisors.
- Roles: E electricians, M mechatronics, A automation, S supervisors.
- Per channel × role: Channels tab (cost per qualified col O, per hire col P, rank col AC).

€102.3k planned across roles and weeks, plus a €20.2k reserve



Why week 1 is biggest: assessments start 22 Oct and an unused slot is lost, so week-1 applications must fill 11 days of slots (22 Oct – 1 Nov). The tests then decide where weeks 3–6 money goes. Week 6 is small: only 24 Nov is still a useful application day.

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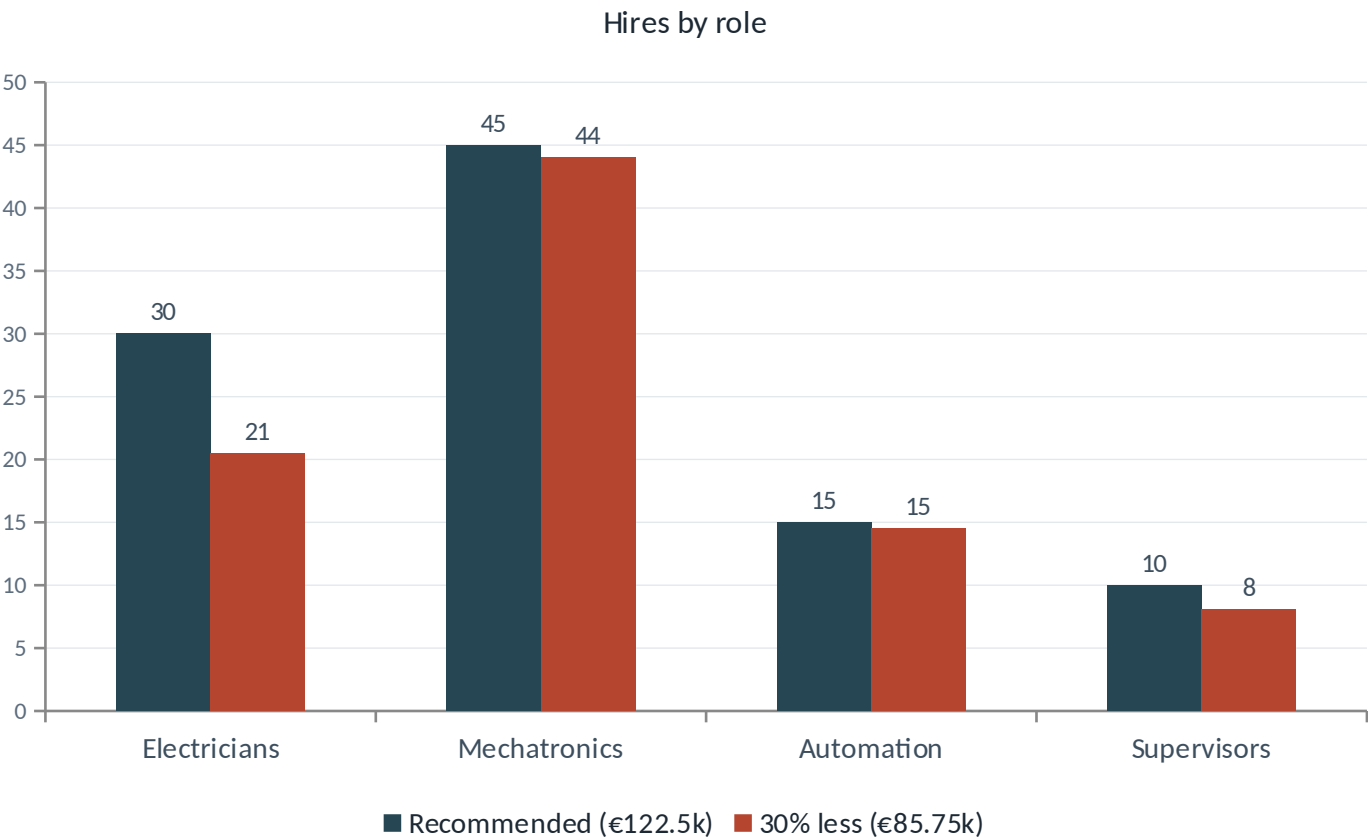
Testing: €9k in weeks 1–2: 12 tests of €750 (programmatic, LinkedIn, Meta, Search × role).

Moving money: weak channels cut from Mon 2 Nov; tests judged by Mon 9 Nov.

Reserve: €20.2k (15% + rounding), released from week 3 only on results.

Paid media stops: Tue 24 Nov, the last useful application date (referral bonuses are paid as people sign).

30% less (€85.75k) signs ~87; electricians fall short first



Budget	Hires	€ per hire (all-in)
Recommended • €122.5k	100	€1,225
30% less • €85.75k	87	€985

Rule: cut the most expensive cost-per-hire channels first; keep the reserve at 15%.

Falls short first: electricians 20.5 of 30, supervisors 8.1 of 10, mechatronics 44.0 of 45, automation 14.5 of 15.

What I'd tell the client: the last €36.75k buys ~13 hires, mostly electricians, the people who keep the lines running. Keep it. If you must cut, the rule cuts the dearest channels, which are mostly electrician and supervisor channels: agree that up front, and cover supervisors by internal promotion.

Three new sources supply ~42 of the 100 hires, one built for electricians



I1 • ATS rediscovery + referral sprint

Who: ~211 past runners-up from the last 12 months (my estimate; the real export replaces it on day 1) + staff referrals

How: Email + SMS waves on days 2, 7 and 14; €1,000 bonus per signed referral

Why better: Already screened and already wanted Tesla; ~€2.50 per application

Maths: €63 + €11k bonuses → 25 re-apps + 66 referrals → ~42 qualified → ~16 hires

2-week test: Wed 21 Oct – Tue 3 Nov (waves 1–3): €63. Pass: ≥14 qualified. Kill: <8 → no further re-contacts; bonus stays live

Who does what: Setup 1 day (live Wed 21 Oct). Me: copy, segments, tracked links. Client: GDPR-checked export, bonus approval, one staff message



I2 • Handwerk → Industrie (electricians)

Who: ~10,000 construction electricians within 75 km

How: Social and search ads with a 6-question quiz; Tesla runs a 2–4 week bridge course

Why better: Certified electricians who never search for plant jobs; more than doubles the hardest pool (10,000 vs 4,800)

Maths: 118 apps × €84 = €9.9k + €1.2k set-up → 30 qualified × 28% = 8.4 hires (€1,329/hire)

2-week test: Fri 23 Oct – Thu 5 Nov (read Mon 9 Nov): €5.6k. Pass: ≥7 qualified at ≤€500. Kill: <4, >€670 per qualified, or profile rejected

Who does what: Setup 3 days (live Fri 23 Oct). Me: ads, quiz, German copywriter. Client: profile sign-off by 23 Oct; its maintenance trainers run the 2–4 week bridge course after signing (onboarding time, not campaign budget)



I3 • Polish border corridor + pre-screener

Who: Mechatronics workers in Polish border towns, 60–130 km away (EU)

How: Polish job boards and Meta; a Polish-speaking freelancer phones each applicant (15 min)

Why better: ~1,700 Polish machine, metal and building workers already commute to Brandenburg (IAB 2020); the call checks language before using our slots. If response is only I2's rate (~219 applications): €132.5k; if it fails: €155k

Maths: 346 apps × €18.75 + €400 → 48 qualified × 37% = 18.0 hires (40% of mech, cap 40%)

2-week test: Tue 27 Oct – Mon 9 Nov (freelancer starts 27 Oct): €3.2k. Pass: ≥12 qualified at ≤€200. Kill: <7, >€270 per qualified, or too few pass the language call

Who does what: Setup 1 week (live Tue 27 Oct). Me: Polish ads, hire the freelancer via rocketjobs.pl (~€19/h), call script, weekly call checks. Client: approve the ads

Repeatable Joveo product: ATS rediscovery. Employers that keep consented past applicants rarely run campaigns to them. Here ~211 records (my estimate) cost ~€14 per hire and fill week-1 slots. Joveo already runs the tracked links and distribution, and its Talent CRM re-engages past applicants, so a consented past-applicant feed becomes one more tracked source, in any market, with no local staff.

Track by source × role weekly, move money on rules, test the riskiest assumptions early



Track (every Monday)

- By source × role: spend, applications, qualified. By role: assessed, passed, offers, signed (each hire keeps its ATS source tag)
- Data: Joveo tracked links + Monday ATS export (source tag), recruiter codes, pre-screener sheet
- Tracker tab turns this into decisions and a hire forecast



Money rules

- Judge a channel only after €500 or 30 applications
- 20% cheaper than plan → +25% a week from the reserve; 50% dearer → halve; 2× → off
- Over 55 qualified next week → pause the dearest; under 50 → release reserve



Check by Mon 2 Nov (confirm 9 Nov)

- Pass rate: first read 2 Nov, confirmed 9 Nov once a role has 10 interviews; if low → tighter knock-out questions, ask for more slots (10% lower ≈ 92 hires)
- Construction electricians: if stopped, programmatic fills the gap (€130k)
- Real test costs: re-rank channels; acceptance read after 5 offers



First five things in week 1

- Tue 20 Oct: kick-off with client; lock slots, 18 Dec date, bonus; request ATS export
- Tue–Wed: launch channels and tests with tracked links
- Wed 21 Oct: past-applicant wave 1 + referral launch
- Wed–Fri: set up Polish ads + freelancer (live 27 Oct); construction campaign live 23 Oct
- Mon 26 Oct: first read-out